



At the **Battle of Karbala** in 680 the **Shi'ite leader al-Husayn ibn Ali** , grandson of Muhammad, was surrounded by Umayyad troops, deprived of water for several days, and eventually killed. His death was proclaimed a **martyrdom** by the Shi'ites, who commemorate it to this day.

In China in 690, the **Empress Wu** finally took the throne in her own name—the only woman in Chinese history to do so—after decades of controlling it through her husband and sons. She even created her own dynasty, **Zhou** , which she headed until 705.



Temple at Tikal
Flanking Tikal's Great Plaza, the 122ft (38m) high Temple II was built during the construction boom of the Late Classic resurgence.



Jerusalem's Dome of the Rock—a shrine sacred to all three Abrahamic faiths—has an octagonal floorplan and a massive gold dome.

3,000

THE NUMBER OF MAJOR STONE BUILDINGS CONSTRUCTED IN TIKAL'S LATE CLASSIC PERIOD

ABD AL-MALIK HAD BECOME CALIPH IN 685, instituting important changes to the way the caliphate was ruled, centralizing government, insisting that all state business was conducted in Arabic, setting up the *barid* (a postal/intelligence gathering service), and issuing, around 697, new coinage: the *dinar* and *dirham*. He also commissioned a great shrine to be built on the

Temple Mount in Jerusalem, the **Dome of the Rock** (or Qubbat as-Sakhrah), completed in 692.

The harsh 10-year rule of the **Byzantine emperor Justinian II** had aroused widespread opposition and in 695 he was deposed and had his nose cut off by **Leontius** , who became emperor in his stead. However, in 698, the **loss of Carthage** , the last Byzantine stronghold in North Africa, to the Arabs led to another revolt and Leontius suffered the same fate as his predecessor.

The turn of the century was a time of change and unrest in the Americas. In North America, the spear was superseded by widespread **adoption of the bow and arrow** . In the Valley of Mexico around 700, the great **city-state of Teotihuacán** , which once housed over 100,000 people, **collapsed** , bringing six centuries of growth and dominance to an end. Social, economic, and environmental factors were probably to blame.

“ I HAVE NOT SEEN THE EQUAL; NEITHER HAVE I HEARD TELL OF ANYTHING... THAT COULD RIVAL IN GRACE THIS DOME OF THE ROCK... ”

Mukaddasi, Arab geographer, c. 10th century

Ancient Teotihuacán mask

This mask was probably tied to a figurine representing a god. The mask would have been decorated with inlays and ear ornaments.

